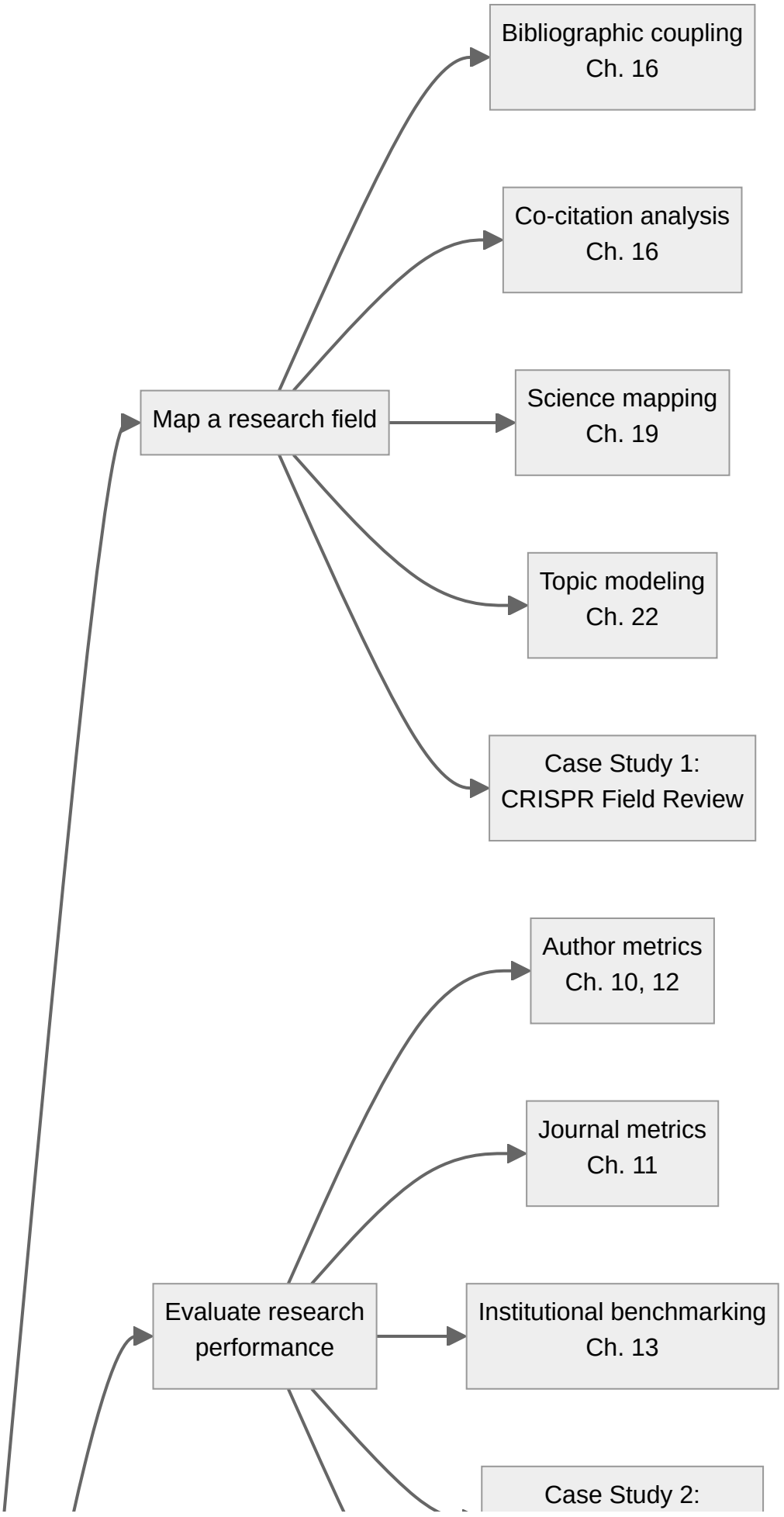
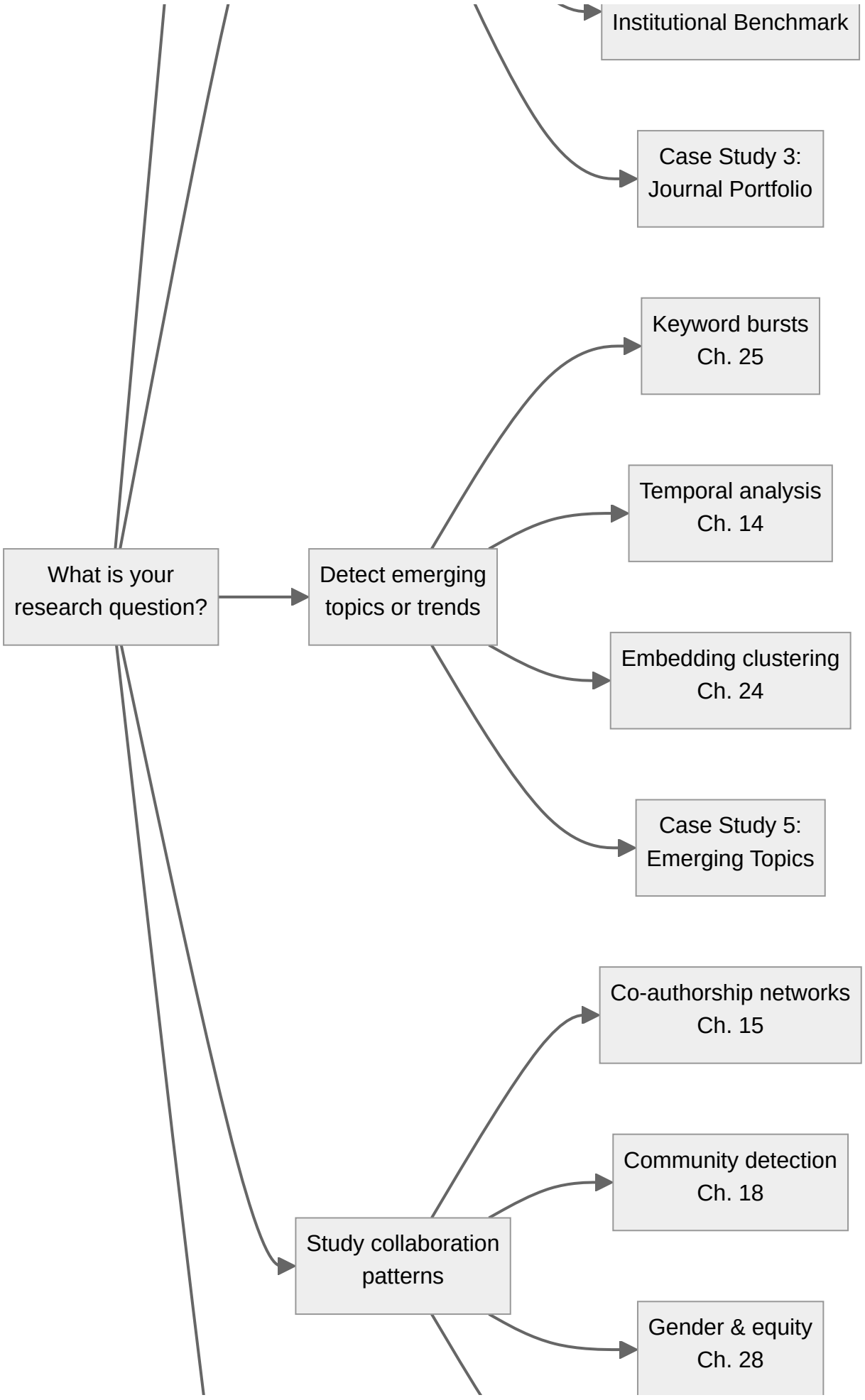
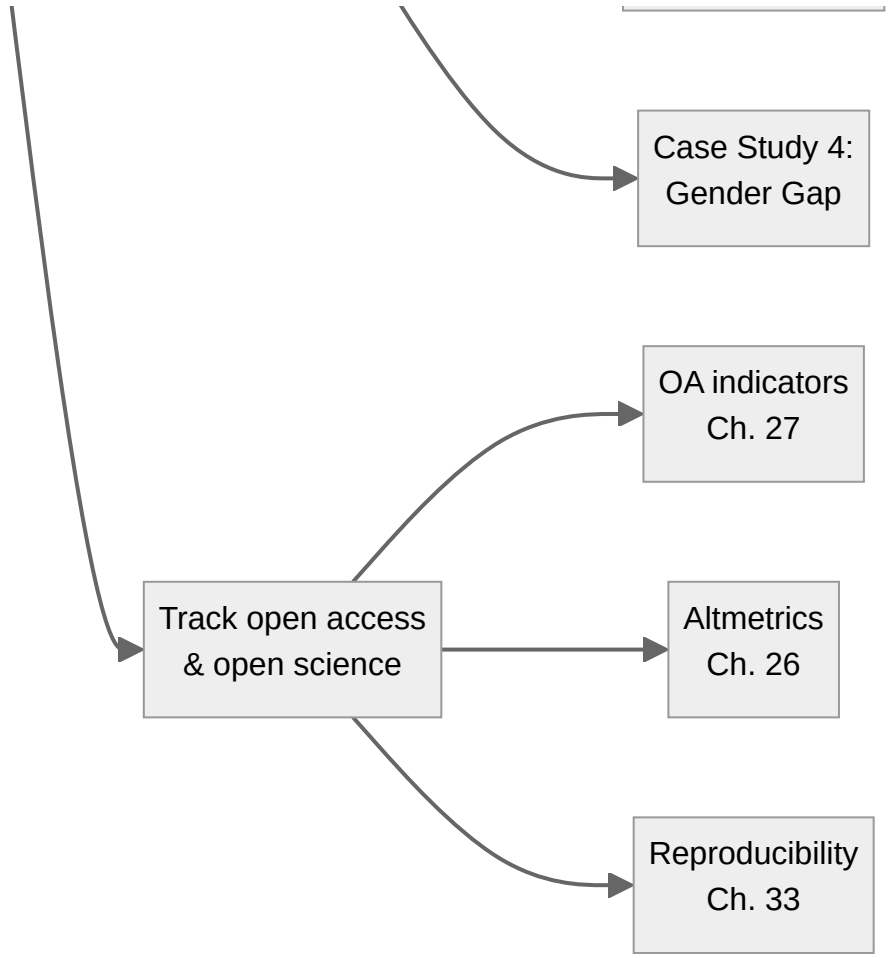
# Find Your Method

*R. Heller · Date: 2026-05-09 · Last changed: 2026-10-31*

Use this decision tree to navigate to the chapter or case study most relevant to your research question. On narrow screens, scroll the diagram horizontally. The quick reference table below provides the same routes in a compact format.


Bibliographic coupling
Ch. 16
Co-citation analysis
Ch. 16
Map a research field
Science mapping
Ch. 19
Topic modeling
Ch. 22
Case Study 1:
CRISPR Field Review
Author metrics
Ch. 10, 12
Journal metrics
Ch. 11
Evaluate research
performance
Institutional benchmarking
Ch. 13
Case Study 2:


Institutional Benchmark
Case Study 3: Journal Portfolio
Keyword bursts Ch. 25
Temporal analysis Ch. 14
What is your research question?
Detect emerging topics or trends
Embedding clustering Ch. 24
Case Study 5: Emerging Topics
Co-authorship networks Ch. 15
Community detection Ch. 18
Study collaboration patterns
Gender & equity Ch. 28




## 0.7 Quick reference table

| Research question | Key chapters | Case study |
|---|---|---|
| Map a research field | 16, 19, 22 | CS 1: CRISPR |
| Evaluate an author | 10, 12 | — |
| Evaluate a journal | 11 | CS 3: Journal Portfolio |
| Benchmark an institution | 13 | CS 2: Institutional |
| Detect emerging topics | 14, 24, 25 | CS 5: Emerging Topics |
| Analyze collaboration | 15, 18 | — |
| Study gender gaps | 28 | CS 4: Gender Gap |
| Track open access | 27 | — |
| Build a dashboard | 35, 37 | — |
| Create a reproducible pipeline | 34, 36 | — |